



Porirua U3A Inc

Newsletter August 2026

Kia ora to all our Porirua U3A members

Brrrr!! winter has arrived with a vengeance with its cold and frosty glory. We, briefly, had snow flurries in Titahi Bay on Tuesday 4th August 2026 renewing memories of the snowcapped Rimutaka and the hills surrounding Porirua. There have also been several frosts in the mornings where the air is crisp and the grass a white blanket. I am enjoying seeing the jonquils and daffodils emerging amid the greenery which tells me that spring won't be far away.

Note from Bill Gebbie (President)

Dear Porirua U3A members

I hope you've kept well during these cold weeks. I was lucky enough to have a sunny week with friends in South Auckland walking, exploring and enjoying one another's company. It was a real tonic.

Listening to a talk about poetry up at Victoria University this week I wondered if some of you might like the opportunity to read, listen to, or even analyse poetry together. If you're interested, and especially if you'd like to coordinate a group, do let me know. There may be Tawa members interested too, and I'll put the idea to them.

I'm often putting ideas and opportunities to you but I'm also very much aware of how busy you often are, spending time helping family, friends and the community. I'm thinking it would be interesting to hear about how you give your time: looking after children perhaps, organising groups, maybe helping a charity.

Perhaps we could make time at our quarterly meetings for one or two of you to tell us what they've been doing?

I'd welcome your thoughts.

I look forward to seeing you at our quarterly meeting on Thursday 20th.

Best wishes, Bill

Quarterly Meetings:

The August quarterly meeting will be held on:

Thursday 20 August 2026 at 12.15pm

The meeting will be held at:

North Baptist Church at 69f Discovery Drive, Whitby, Porirua 5024

The meeting will include a catered shared lunch followed by the speaker at 1pm. We are not asking for a koha at this meeting.

Quest speaker – Quarterly meeting

The Guest Speaker will be:

Claire Giblin – Asset Planning Manager, Porirua City Council

Claire will explain how the Porirua City Council's roading and pavement capital and maintenance programmes are managed. This is a major area of annual expenditure and as ratepayers and residents we are all affected. Renier Ackerman, the maintenance and delivery team manager will also be available to answer questions. This will be an excellent opportunity to learn about an important part of Porirua City Council delivery and a major area of annual expenditure

Day Trips and other Events

See Bill's emails for trips that he is organising.

Executive Committee 2025/2026

Bill Gebbie President porirua3a@gmail.com (027 667 0180)

Christine Healy Secretary porirua3a@gmail.com (027 647 8919)

Christine de Roo Treasurer/Membership porirua3a@gmail.com (021 121 0218)

Michael Lynch Interest Groups Co-Ordinator m.lynch@xtra.co.nz (022 606 8066)

Marcia Forsman Catering (021 406 570)

Collin Russell Speakers/Liaison with Tawa U3A (027 247 3399)

Colin Brown Website (028 413 2372)

If you have any ideas which you would like the committee to consider please be in touch. We look forward to seeing you all at the Quarterly meeting on **20 August 2026**.

Christine Healy

Secretary

Porirua U3A